9815

Rotary District 9815
President-Elect Learning & Development

My Presidential *Plan*

From *Why me?* to *Why not me?* A one-page plan for your year, built one question at a time.

Name _____

Club _____

Rotary year _____

My Membership Chair _____

My mentor _____

START HERE

A plan, not a *wish list*

Many clubs no longer have someone who has "been there" to walk beside a new President. Think of this workbook as the mentor in your pocket. It asks the questions a good mentor would ask. Your answers become a plan you can take to your Board, your Assistant Governor and Rotary Club Central.

1 · Where are we now?
Members, trends, projects, money and mood. Be honest.

2 · Where do we want to be on 30 June?
Picture your changeover night.

3 · What will we do to get there?
Two or three goals, each with a number and an owner.

How to use it

- **Work through it in order.** Short answers are fine, and pencil is better than perfect.
- **Do the membership pages with your Membership Chair.** Rate the club separately first, then compare.
- **Talk it through with a mentor.** A past President from any club, your Assistant Governor, or someone from your PELDS group.
- **Make it official** by putting your goals into Rotary Club Central (steps on page 4).
- **Prefer to type?** The PE Toolkit asks the same questions online, saves your answers and prints your plan. The AI coach can even question your plan for you.

DISTRICT 9815 MEMBERSHIP GROWTH STRATEGY 2026–2029

To build magnetic, diverse, sustainable Rotary and Rotaract clubs. Our goal: grow District membership by **15% over three years**, while improving engagement, diversity, retention and club vitality. These move together. Members rarely leave Rotary; they leave a club experience that doesn't work for them.

Five pathways: intentional attraction · member retention · diversity, inclusion and flexible participation · club experience and engagement · connections with Rotary programs and the community.

PART 1

My why, and our club *today*

Why did I say yes to being President? "Nobody else would" is a real answer too.

It's 30 June, my changeover night. A member stands up to thank me. What do I hope they say?

Our club in numbers

Measure	Today	Three years ago	Notes
Members			
Joined in the last two years			
Left in the last two years			
Regular attendance			
Main projects and fundraisers			

Three things we do really well

Three things that frustrate members (or me)

PART 2

My two or three *goals*

Most successful Presidents pick two or three goals and do them well. Think membership, a signature project, Foundation giving, youth or public image.

Goal	Success on 30 June looks like… (a number or something you can see)	Who leads it	First step
1			
2			
3			

The one project our community will connect with our club this year

How will people outside the club hear about our year? Local paper, Facebook, website, signage, events. Who looks after it?

MAKE IT OFFICIAL · ROTARY CLUB CENTRAL

1. Go to **my.rotary.org** and **Sign in** (or **Register** with the email your club has for you).
2. Open **Rotary Club Central** and choose the **right Rotary year** at the top.
3. Look at your club's **history and trends** first, then set a realistic membership goal.
4. Add your **Foundation** giving goals, and **Save** each one before moving on.

Not sure when you can enter goals as President-Elect? Ask your District Secretary or Assistant Governor.

PART 3 · WITH YOUR MEMBERSHIP CHAIR

Membership starts *with you*

Club experience health check

Rate each statement 1 (not yet) to 5 (absolutely). Rate it separately, then compare. The differences are where the best conversations are.

Statement	President	Membership Chair
Members enjoy our club and feel they belong	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5
Members trust our leaders and feel they have a say	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5
Members can learn and grow here	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5
Members have made real friendships through the club	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5
Our service clearly makes a difference	1 2 3 4 5	1 2 3 4 5

My membership pledge

Two people I will personally invite to a project or event	
How I will welcome every new member, and the job I'll give them in their first month	
One member who seems to be drifting that I will call this month	

Our President and Membership Chair agreement

Our membership goal for 30 June (for Club Central), and one retention goal	
The President will...	
The Membership Chair will...	
Our two or three attraction pathways (projects first, Friends of Rotary, personal invitation, flexible models, alumni and youth...)	
New members get: a support contact, induction within 90 days, check-ins at 3, 6 and 12 months. Who does it?	
When we'll review it with the Board	

PART 4

My team and *my support*

Board role	Name	Confirmed?
Secretary		
Treasurer		
Membership Chair		
Service / Projects		
Public Image		
Foundation		
President-Nominee / successor		
Other		

Who will be my mentor or sounding board? Any club.

What will I hand over or stop doing, so I have time to lead?

What I'll ask them for (coffee monthly, a call when stuck, read my plan…)

How will I look after myself and my family this year?

Who could be President in two or three years, and how will I help them grow?

My first three moves

This week	
This month	
Before 1 July	

YOUR YEAR

The year at a *glance*

From the Leadership Hub's Year Planner. Tick them off as you go.

Before 1 July

- ☐ PELDS, and your one-page plan
- ☐ Board confirmed, planning day booked
- ☐ Goals in Rotary Club Central
- ☐ Grant-ready: Grants Seminar (May)
- ☐ Handover with the outgoing President

Q1 · July – September

- ☐ Share your vision with the club
- ☐ Budget and Board roles confirmed
- ☐ Membership and Foundation goals set
- ☐ Connect with your Assistant Governor
- ☐ District Assembly with your Board

Q2 · October – December

- ☐ Major service project
- ☐ Review membership; call at-risk members
- ☐ Foundation month (November)
- ☐ Mid-year Board review
- ☐ Thank and recognise members

Q3 · January – March

- ☐ Membership drive: peak recruitment time
- ☐ Stretch roles for emerging leaders
- ☐ District Grant applications
- ☐ President-Elect more visible
- ☐ Board self-review

Q4 · April – June

- ☐ Year-end impact report for the AGM
- ☐ District Conference
- ☐ Grant reports and acquittals
- ☐ Handover notes and formal handover
- ☐ Celebrate!

Every month: ten minutes with your mentor

- Who have I thanked? Who has gone quiet?
- Are Board meetings finishing on time?
- Which goal is on track, and which needs help?
- What could I hand over?
- Am I enjoying this? If not, why not?

One habit that changes Board meetings: open every meeting with *"What is the most important thing we could decide today?"* Send the agenda 48 hours ahead, give every action an owner and a date, and finish by recognising one member.

YOU'RE NOT ON YOUR OWN

Where to find *help*

Scan a code with your phone camera, or type the address. **Your Assistant Governor is always your first call.**

PE Toolkit
david-rotary.github.io/PELDS2026

Leadership Hub
rotary9815.org.au/page/leadership-flow

Membership Hub
rotary9815.org.au/page/membership-flow

Club Assist
rotarysouthpacific.org · choose Victoria + "Club President"

My Rotary + Club Central
my.rotary.org

Rotary Learning Center
learn.rotary.org · My Rotary login

Worth doing before 1 July

- **Learning Center courses:** Club President Essentials (parts 1 and 2), Is Your Club Healthy?, Strategies for Attracting New Members, Best Practices for Engaging Your Members.
- **Rotary's *Strengthening Your Membership* guide** (in the PE Toolkit Library): Club Health Check, member satisfaction survey and exit survey.
- **In the PE Toolkit:** "Your mentor for the year", "Membership: you and your Membership Chair", and practise the hard conversations with the AI coach.

Useful names and numbers

Who	Name	Phone / email
My Assistant Governor		
My mentor		
District Membership Chair		
District Youth Protection Officer		

You said yes. That's the hardest part done.
Let's build the leader it makes you.